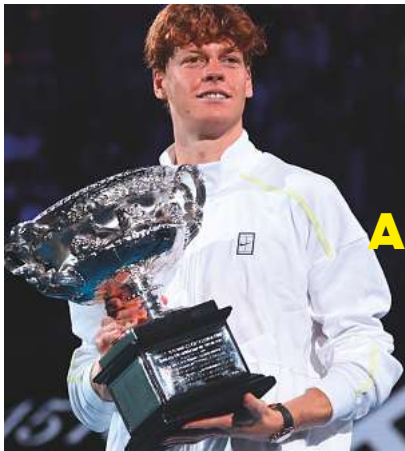


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Trump wants Egypt, Jordan to take in Gazans

PALESTINE AND JORDAN CONDEMN ANY
PLANS TO RELOCATE PALESTINIANS

GAZA STRIP

US President Donald Trump floated a plan to “just clean out” Gaza, and said he wants Egypt and Jordan to take Palestinians from the territory, as a fragile truce between Israel and Hamas aimed at permanently ending the war entered its second week yesterday.

Trump called Gaza a “demolition site” and said he had spoken to Jordan’s King Abdullah II about moving Palestinians out of the territory. “I’d like Egypt to take people. And I’d like Jordan to take people,” Trump told reporters aboard Air Force One, adding he expected to talk to Egyptian President Abdel Fattah el-Sisi.

Forced displacement

Palestinian president Mahmoud Abbas condemned “any projects” to relocate the people of Gaza outside the territory. Abbas “expressed strong rejection and condemnation of any projects aimed at displacing our people from the Gaza Strip”, a statement from his office said.

Jordanian Foreign Minister Ayman Safadi said yesterday

his kingdom firmly rejects any forced displacement of Palestinians, following remarks by Trump suggesting Gazans should be sent to Egypt and Jordan.

“You’re talking about probably a million and half people, and we just clean out that whole thing,” Trump said of Gaza, whose population is about 2.4 million, adding that “something has to happen”.

“I’d rather get involved with some of the Arab nations and build housing at a different location where they can maybe live in peace for a change,” Trump said, adding that moving Gaza’s inhabitants could be “temporarily or could be long term”.

—AFP
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For Palestinians, any attempt to move them from Gaza would evoke dark memories of what the Arab world calls the ‘Nakba’ or catastrophe — the mass displacement of Palestinians during Israel’s creation 75 years ago.



AFP

■ Residents carry a man injured by Israeli fire in Burj Al Muluk, south Lebanon, yesterday. Hundreds tried to return to their homes on the deadline for Israeli forces to withdraw from the area.

22 killed in Lebanon as Israeli troops fire at displaced residents

Citizens were returning home on deadline for troop withdrawal

BURJ AL MULUK, LEBANON

The Lebanese health ministry said the Israeli army opened fire yesterday on residents of southern Lebanon trying to return to their villages, killing 22 people and wounding dozens, health officials said as hundreds of people tried to return to their homes on the deadline for Israel to withdraw.

Israel was all but certain to miss yesterday’s deadline, which is part of a ceasefire agreement that ended its war with the Iran-backed Hezbollah group two months ago.

The deal that took effect on November 27 said the Lebanese army was to deploy alongside United Nations peacekeepers in the south as the Israeli army withdrew over a 60-day period.

That period ended yesterday.

Lebanon’s health ministry said Israeli forces opened fire on “citizens who were trying to return to their villages”,

killing 15 and wounding 83. The ministry’s toll includes a soldier from the Lebanese army, which also announced his death and said Israeli fire had wounded another soldier.

AFP journalists said convoys of vehicles carrying hundreds of people, some flying yellow Hezbollah flags, were trying to get to several villages despite the Israeli military’s continued presence.

“We will return to our villages and the Israeli enemy will leave,” even if it costs lives, said Ali Harb, a 27-year-old trying to go to Kfar Kila.

—AFP

Dubai realty market at record high

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

There were 2.78 million procedures within the Dubai real estate market all through 2024 — and the highest by the sector ever.

These include property and plot deals as well as rental agreements, representing a 17 per cent gain on 2023. Real estate specific transactions alone came to 226,000, with a combined value of Dh761 billion, a 36 per cent growth in volume and 20 per cent growth in value year-on-year.

Exceptional results

In a statement, Shaikh Hamdan Bin Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE, and Chairman of The Executive Council of Dubai, said: “The exceptional results in 2024 reflect the deep strength and resilience of our economy, which continues to thrive in a rapidly changing global landscape. Dubai’s real estate market remains among the world’s best.”

There were 110,000 new investors to Dubai’s real estate sector through last year, as the offplan launch and sales boom continued. In all, 217,000 investments recorded by the sector last year were valued at an impressive Dh526 billion.



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